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Global Markets Strategy

18 September 2026

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Treasuries

What's your part? Who you are

- 1y1y OIS has reached new highs following this week's hawkish FOMC outcome. Chair Warsh's comments indicate this move was merely a mark to market: given upside growth risks, a labor market in balance, and above-target inflation, we should be braced for a series of hikes
 - Current valuations are attractive, particularly at the front end, but we are not in a rush to step in and add duration exposure: using 1999-2000 as a guide, the front end overshot relative to the Fed's actual delivery...
 - ...moreover, yields tend to follow through higher after the first hike in more limited and full-blown easing cycles, suggesting there is a risk yields continue to rise...
 - ...finally, valuations remain expensive, and our *Treasury Client Survey* does not indicate investors are braced for multiple hikes: maintain 10s/20s/30s belly-cheapening butterflies as a low-beta bearish trade with some relative value
 - We raise our YE26 2-year Treasury target by 40bp to 4.70%, and our 10-year target by 20bp to 5.05%
 - The July TIC data show foreign investors net sold \$3.6bn long-term Treasuries, the first net month of selling since December 2025. Selling was concentrated in Canada and the Euro Area
-

Market views

The Treasury curve twisted flatter once again this week, as 2-, 5-, and 10-year yields rose 10bp, 7bp, and 3bp, respectively, while long-end yields declined 2bp. In contrast to prior weeks, the US underperformed its DM peers in this move, amid a hawkish outcome at the FOMC meeting on Wednesday (**Figure 1**). As expected, the Fed raised rates by 25bp, in its first hike since July 2023, but Chair Warsh's press conference on Wednesday afternoon drove the move, as we could discern hawkishness in his reaction function. In the prepared remarks, Warsh argued that "we removed a dose of accommodation," and repeated this twice more during the Q&A. When paired with his comments that he "would be hard pressed to describe broad financial conditions as restrictive," this indicates that the Chair does not believe policy is restrictive and will require higher rates to bring inflation back to target. Moreover, when asked about the commitment to price stability, Warsh stated that "today's action starts to show we are serious about this," indicating this was unlikely to be just a "one and done" hiking cycle.

Taken together, we can discern that if the Chair thought policy was accommodative before today's moves, as ratified by strong growth and loose financial conditions, then this is more likely to be a series of hikes. Indeed, our Federal Reserve NLP reads his prepared remarks as more hawkish than even his Jackson Hole Speech, with the prepared remarks the most relevant for monetary policy that the Chair has had in his short tenure (**Figure 2**).

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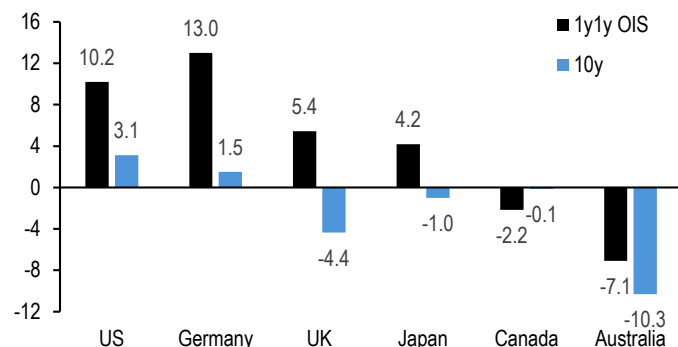
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Figure 1: The curve bearishly flattened this week and the US underperformed its DM peers as the FOMC delivered a hawkish hike...

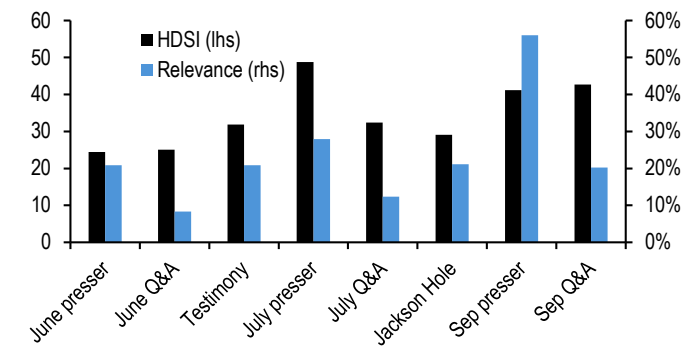
Changes in various DM 1y1y and 10-year government bonds yields, 9/11/26-9/18/26, bp



Source: J.P. Morgan

Figure 2: ...as Warsh's press conference and Q&A flagged hawkishly, with a much higher relevance for monetary policy as well

Hawk-Dove * and Relevance scores for Chair Warsh's appearances

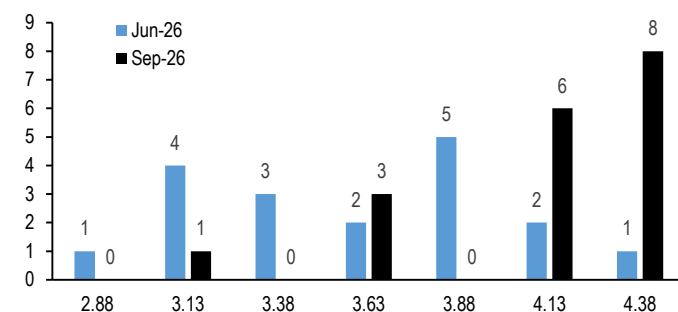


Source: J.P. Morgan

Away from the press conference, the overall FOMC delivery was very important in level setting on the direction of travel on Treasury yields into year end. The FOMC decision was unanimous, and the SEP skewed somewhat hawkishly as well: the median participant looks for one more hike this year, and expects policy rates to hold steady in 2027. This is dovish relative to market pricing, but the distribution of the 2027 dots shows 8 participants project an additional hike next year (**Figure 3**). Moreover, the longer-run dot rose to 3.25%, its highest level in a decade (see [Committee wants another dose](#), Michael Feroli, 9/16/26). Finally, it does not seem like Warsh is alone in his assessment of the economy: **Figure 4** shows that the risks to growth were more skewed to the upside in the latest SEP than they have been at any point since they were first introduced in 2007.

Figure 3: The 2027 dot distribution leans hawkishly...

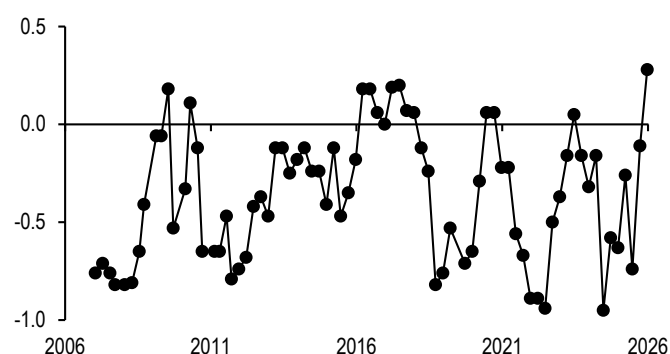
Distribution of projected midpoint of fed funds target range for 2027, June 2026 vs. September 2026; number of participants



Source: Federal Reserve

Figure 4: ...and forecasts show most upside risk to committee real GDP growth forecasts in SEP history; indicating a mandate in better balance

Diffusion index of Federal Reserve participants' risks around their GDP projections; %



* For each SEP, participants provided responses to the question "Please indicate your judgment of the risk weighting around your projections." Each point in the diffusion indexes represents the number of participants who responded "Weighted to the Upside" minus the number who responded "Weighted to the Downside," divided by the total number of participants.

Source: Federal Reserve

Given this backdrop, Fed policy expectations have made new highs, with OIS forwards now pricing in 33bp of hikes by YE26 and a total of 77bp of hikes by 3Q27, leaving 1y1y OIS at even higher levels than persisted during the 2022-2023 tightening cycle (**Figure 5**). Now to be clear, this is more than our own forecast, which looks for one more hike at the December meeting, but we think this pricing could persist for a number of reasons. Our colleagues

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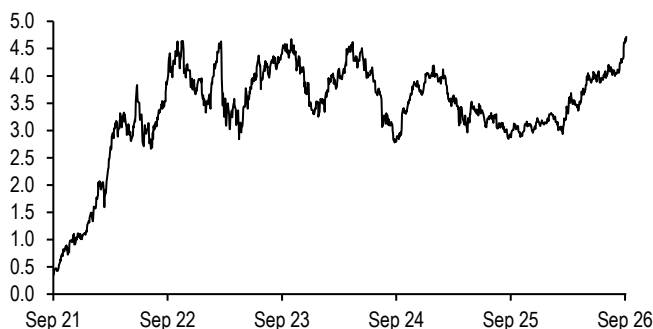
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in global economics like to call this the “6-7 economy” as there are parallels to draw versus 1986-1987 and 1996-1997, given the resilience of the economy and firm inflation. The Fed did raise rates sharply in 1987, while in 1997 it hiked only once before the Asian currency crisis halted the process. To the extent that the Fed communicated differently in 1987 than it does now, and the starting level of rates was significantly higher, we find it difficult to compare the current environment with that era 40 years ago.

Instead, we’ve argued that the 1999-2000 period is the best analog: when we take away the first 75bp of hikes that reversed the cuts around the Russian debt crisis and the failure of LTCM, the Fed went on to raise rates by 100bp amid firm growth and inflation. In that vein, we’ve argued for some time that the money markets should price 50-100bp of cumulative tightening if labor markets continued to show signs of reduced slack. Our interest rate forecasts reflected the likelihood markets would price in the lower- to middle of that expected range. However, in the context of Chair Warsh’s comments and other developments at the FOMC meeting, we think OIS forwards are warranted in pricing in the upper end of this range, for a number of reasons. If this is indeed the beginning of a series of hikes, history would indicate that it’s very unlikely rates will pause here. **Figure 6** shows the period in the months around the first hike in a cycle, using 1999, 2004, 2016, and 2022 as a guide. This demonstrates that the bulk of the rise in yields and curve flattening occurs in anticipation of the first hike, but that it generally follows through in the following months. **Accordingly, while the front end does look optically attractive at current levels, we are hesitant to fade this move, being respectful of current dynamics and the typical behavior around the onset of other tightening cycles.**

Figure 5: 1y1y OIS has made new highs, climbing above the prior high during the 2022-2023 hiking cycle

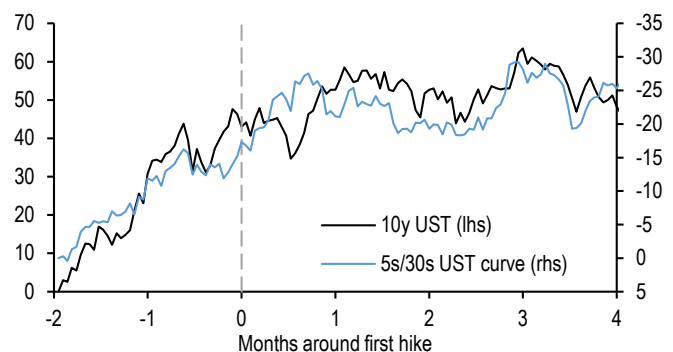
1y1y OIS rates; %



Source: J.P. Morgan

Figure 6: Yields tend to continue their ascent and the curve tends to flatten further after the first hike in a cycle

Cumulative change in 10-year Treasury yields (lhs, %) and 5s/30s Treasury curve (inverted rhs; bp) in months around the first Fed hike in a cycle*; bp



* Dates used: 6/30/99, 6/30/04, 12/14/16, 3/16/22, 9/16/26)
Source: J.P. Morgan

We are also aware that valuations continue to flag somewhat expensive in our valuation framework, and this should be an impediment to a sharp retracement in yields as well. Ten-year yields are currently trading 20bp too low in our fair-value framework, a divergence of more than one standard deviation. While the model does not mean revert quickly, and yields have been trading below their model-implied fair value since late-spring, this does give us pause (**Figure 7**). Finally, our latest *Treasury Client Survey* shows investors have pared back duration overweights in recent weeks, but the survey index leaned more bearishly in the limited 2016-2018 tightening cycle as well as the historic 2023-2023 cycle (**Figure 8**). Using these two recent cycles as a guide, current positioning does not indicate investors are braced for a series of hikes, and a wholesale reduction in duration overweights could also

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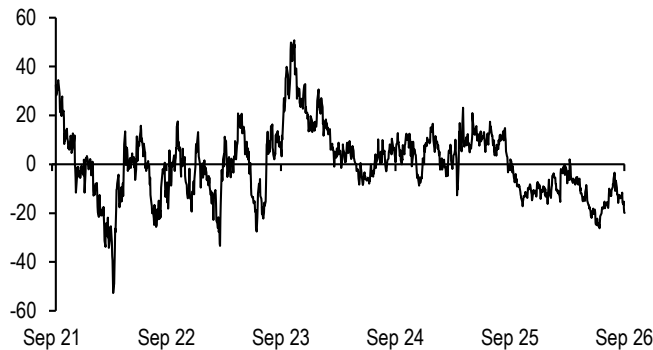
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drive yields higher. **Net of these factors, we remain neutral on duration, and continue to hold 10s/20s/30s belly-cheapening butterflies for a low-beta bearish position with some relative value.**

Figure 7: 10-year yields are near 20-year highs, but remain 20bp too low in our valuation framework...

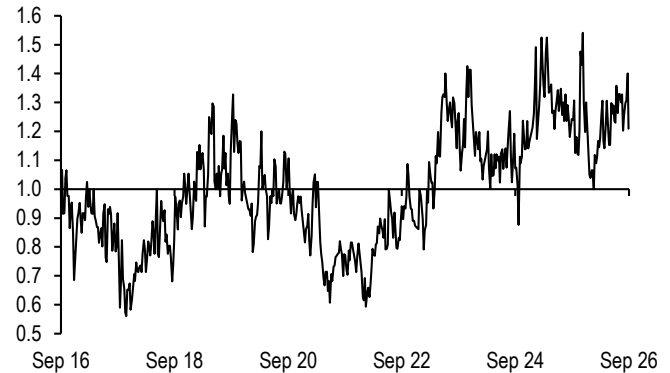
Residual of J.P. Morgan 10-year Treasury fair value model*; bp



*10-year Treasury yields regressed on 1y1y OIS rates (%), 5y5y seasonally-adjusted TIPS breakevens (%), J.P. Morgan U.S. Forecast Revision Index (%), Fed B/S as share of the US economy (%), and a dummy variable for trade policy uncertainty that is 1 between 4/2/25 and 2/26/26. Regression over the last 5 years: R-squared = 9.3%, SE = 13.9bp
Source: J.P. Morgan, Federal Reserve

Figure 8: ...and positioning has not swung to the short side, as it did in the prior two tightening cycles

J.P. Morgan Treasury Client Survey Index*;



* (Longs + Neutrals)/(Shorts + Neutrals)
Source: J.P. Morgan

Given this backdrop, we believe current pricing is appropriate, and we introduce our updated interest rate forecast in Figure 9. Notably, we raise our YE26 2-year Treasury target by 40bp to 4.70%, and our 10-year target by 20bp, to 5.05%. This updated forecast reflects three core themes: first, that it is too early to fade this move in yields, as markets overshot in 2000, pricing in a terminal rate almost 75bp higher than the Fed would deliver, and this terminal rate was not priced until much deeper in that cycle. Second, we expect some mean reversion to occur: intermediate Treasury yields have been trading 10-25bp below their model implied fair value since mid-spring, and we think this gap could close over time. Finally, this indicates that the move to higher yields, which has been deliberate and orderly thus far, should slow in the coming months.

Figure 9: We revise our YE26 10-year forecast 20bp higher to 5.05%

J.P. Morgan US interest rate forecast; %

Maturity	Actual	1m	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	2Q27
	18 Sep 26	19 Oct 26	31 Dec 26	31 Mar 27	30 Jun 27	30 Sep 27
Fed funds	3.88	3.90	4.15	4.15	4.15	4.15
SOFR	3.85	3.90	4.15	4.15	4.15	4.15
2-yr UST	4.74	4.75	4.70	4.65	4.60	4.55
3-yr UST	4.82	4.80	4.75	4.70	4.65	4.60
5-yr UST	4.85	4.85	4.90	4.95	4.90	4.85
7-yr UST	4.92	4.95	5.00	5.05	5.00	4.95
10-yr UST	5.00	5.00	5.05	5.10	5.05	5.00
20-yr UST	5.37	5.40	5.45	5.50	5.45	5.40
30-yr UST	5.33	5.35	5.45	5.50	5.45	5.45

Source: J.P. Morgan

July TIC update

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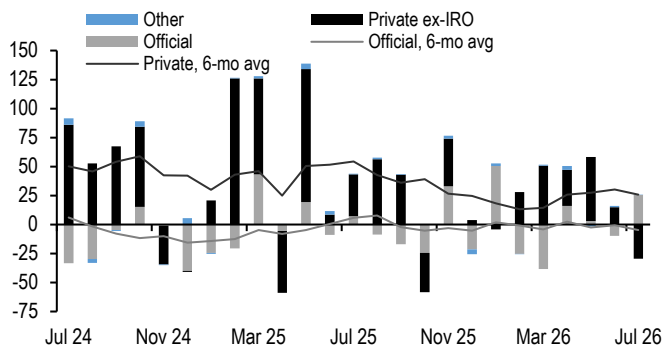
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Treasury released the monthly TIC data for July earlier this week, showing that foreign investors net sold \$3.6bn long-term Treasuries, the first net month of selling since December 2025. The details were somewhat bifurcated: private investors shed \$29.3bn, the fastest pace of selling since last October, while foreign official accounts bought \$25.5bn, their largest monthly inflow since January (**Figure 10**). More timely custody holdings data similarly show that foreign ownership of Treasuries stabilized in July, before trending somewhat lower in August, though we caution that the data set represents less than 75% of total official holdings. Notably, while foreign officials net bought long-term Treasuries, they shed \$6.2bn of short-term holdings, bringing the foreign ownership of total T-bills outstanding to 5.1% and continuing the reversal of the general trend we've seen over the past several years.

Geographically, sales emanated primarily from Canada, followed by the Euro Area and Japan (**Figure 11**). Canadian flows have been quite volatile from month-to-month, and indeed this month of selling follows two strong months of strong demand. Within the Euro Area, selling was concentrated in Belgium and France. More granular data from the MoF reveals that among Japanese investors, lifers drove most of the selling in July. Moreover, this data suggests selling flows continued in August, driven by banks, while Trust banks net bought over the month (see [Japan Flows in Pictures](#), Takafumi Yamawaki, 9/8/26). Sources of demand in July were concentrated in India and in several major financial centers and domiciles known for hedge fund activity—as we have previously commented, custodial bias clouds our assessment of these holdings, as the large share of transactions from these domiciles could reflect other foreign accounts

Figure 10: Foreign investors net sold \$3.6bn long-term Treasuries in July, the first month of shedding this year, driven by private investors...

Total net sales of long-term Treasuries by US residents by investor type and 6-month moving average; \$bn



Source: Treasury International Capital System

Figure 11: ...selling was concentrated in Canada and the Euro Area, India and Hong Kong were the largest buyers

Net sales of long-term Treasuries by US residents from May 2026 - Jul 2026 by top 5 net buyers and net sellers in July, as well as YTD total*; \$bn

Region	Jul-26	Jun-26	May-26	YTD 2026
India	15.2	3.4	2.3	20.0
Hong Kong	11.0	-5.7	14.8	33.4
Norway	7.1	-4.2	-5.7	4.3
Cayman Islands	6.9	-10.1	-5.9	5.3
United Kingdom	5.3	-4.4	6.9	126.4
Canada	-32.1	26.0	39.0	-35.8
Euro Area*	-10.8	10.4	-3.3	1.6
Japan	-8.8	-3.8	-2.8	-11.5
China	-7.7	-15.8	-0.1	-48.0
Singapore	-5.7	4.7	1.1	1.5

* Euro area includes Austria, Belgium, Cyprus, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Ireland, Italy, Latvia, Luxembourg, Malta, Netherlands, Portugal, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain

Source: Treasury International Capital System

Looking ahead, given more attractive valuations in home currency government bonds, we expect foreign private demand to generally remain muted. As we do not expect official demand to firm materially, we forecast \$450bn in foreign demand this year (see [Treasuries 2026 Mid-Year Outlook](#), *US Fixed Income Markets Weekly*, 6/12/26). **Given that foreign demand has totalled just \$174bn through July, we see some downside risk to this forecast.**

Trade recommendations

- Maintain 10s/20s/30s belly-cheapening butterflies

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- Stay long 50% risk, or \$32.1mn notional of T 4.625% Aug-36s
- Stay short 100% risk, or \$41.2mn notional of T 5.125% Aug-46s
- Stay long 50% risk, or \$16.9mn notional of T 5.125% Aug-56s
- (*US Treasury Market Daily*, 9/4/26: P/L since inception: -2.7bp)

• Stay short 10-year Treasuries versus 10-year Bunds

- Stay short 100% risk, or \$121.2mn notional of T 4.375% May-36s versus long €100mn DBR 2.90% Feb-36s
- (*Trade note: Enter long 10Y Germany vs. US*, 6/5/26: P/L since inception: 3.5bp)

• Maintain 2.375% May-51 / 5.0% May-56s curve flatteners

- Stay short 100% risk, or \$25.1mn notional of T 2.375% May-51s
- Stay long 100% risk, or \$16.6mn notional of T 5% May-56s
- (*US Fixed Income Markets Weekly*, 5/15/26: P/L since inception: -1.7bp)

Figure 12: Closed trades in the last 12 months

P/L reported in bp of yield unless otherwise indicated

TRADE	ENTRY	EXIT	P/L
Duration			
10-year duration short	09/12/25	10/16/25	-8.4
50:50 weighted 2s/5s/10s belly-cheapening butterflies	11/25/25	12/10/25	4.9
2-year duration shorts	02/12/25	03/05/26	13.9
2-year duration longs	03/20/26	04/02/26	9.4
50:50 weighted 2s/5s/10s belly-cheapening butterflies	03/06/26	05/15/26	3.7
2-year duration longs	05/15/26	06/04/26	3.8
Curve			
5s/20s steepeners	07/25/25	11/24/25	0.6
2s/5s flatteners	12/16/25	01/05/26	-2.6
10s/30s flatteners	01/09/26	01/20/26	1.9
5s/20s steepeners	01/28/26	02/06/26	6.2
5s/20s steepeners	02/20/26	03/11/26	0.7
10s/30s flatteners	06/12/26	07/13/26	-0.4
5s/30s flatteners	07/24/26	07/29/26	-5.8
2s/10s steepeners	07/31/26	08/28/26	-7.6
Relative value			
100% 5s/7s steepeners paired with 42% 10s/30s flatteners	08/06/25	09/19/25	-4.0
53:54 3.25 Jun-27s/4.875 Oct-30s/3.5 Feb-33s belly-cheapening butterflies	07/11/25	10/03/25	1.2
67:37 4.00 Jun-32s/4.25 Aug-35s/4.75 Aug-55s belly-cheapening butterflies	10/03/25	12/19/25	-3.4
50:50 weighted 5s/10s/30s belly-cheapening butterflies	10/31/25	06/12/26	-5.8
Term premium			
64:11 weighted 3s/10s/30s belly-cheapening butterfly	05/02/25	11/24/25	-18.3
Number of positive trades			10
Number of negative trades			9
Hit rate			53%
Aggregate P/L			-10.0

Source: J.P. Morgan

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